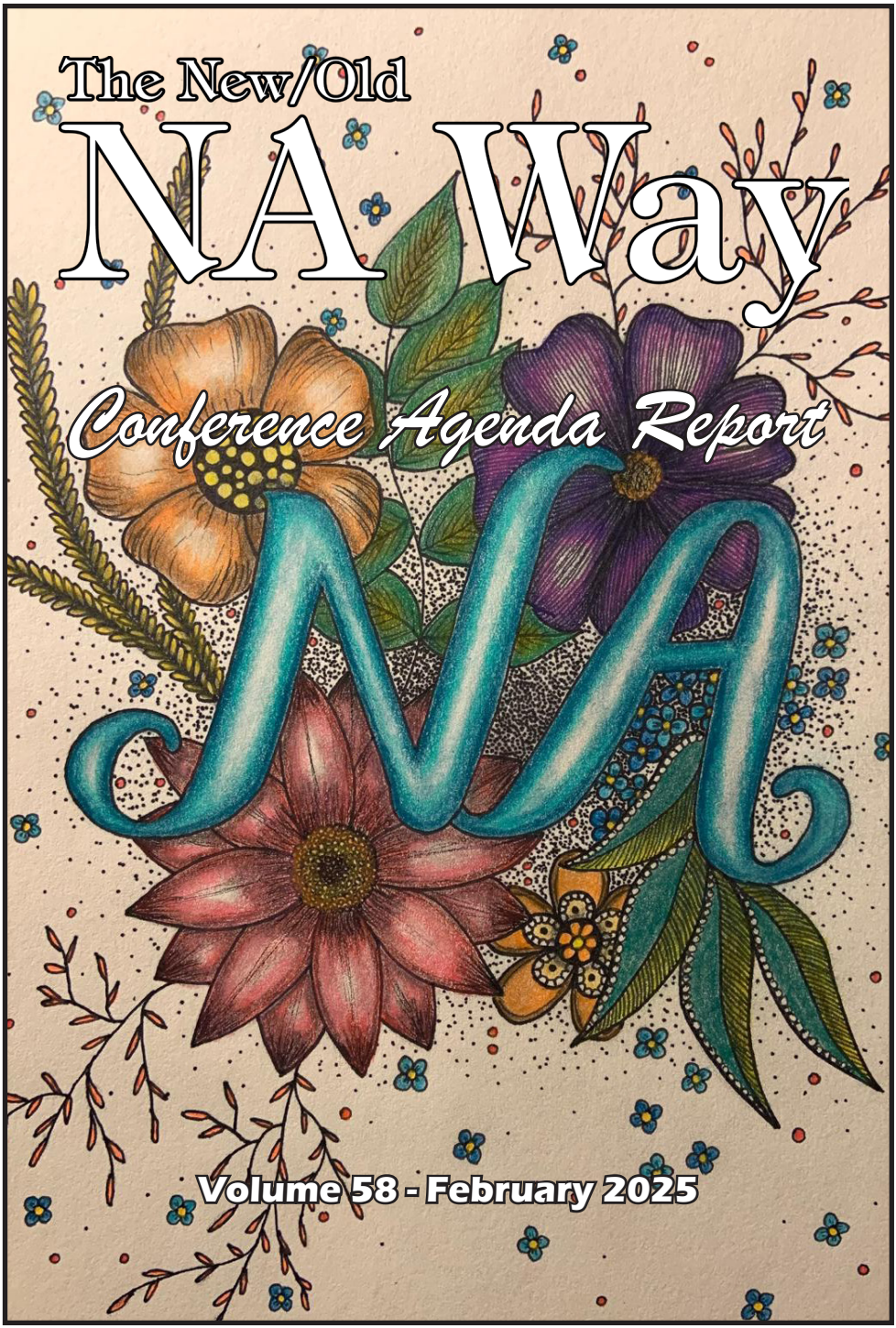

The New/Old
NA Way
Conference Agenda Report
NA
Volume 58 - February 2025



The New/Old NA WAY Magazine
Volume 58 - February 2025
This magazine was written in open participation by
members of the Groups of The Anonymi Foundation and
members of the Groups who participate in the
Fellowship Service Conference and the
European Felloswhip Service Conference

The New/Old NA Way

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My Gratitude Speaks
When I Care
And When I Share
With Others
The NA Way

Conference Agenda Report

F.S.C. 2025

Fellowship **S**ervice **C**onference
for Narcotics Anonymous

CHAIR REPORT

1-12-2025

Dear fellow addicts and Groups of the Fellowship Service Conference. It's the beginning of a new year and that means we can start preparing for the Conference in June. It's the Annual Conference where the Groups of the Anonymi Foundation bring their votes and discuss matters regarding our Fellowship.

There has been some input from Groups on the proposals, so the Groups that brought the proposals needed some time to process the input and make the changes they saw fit. The two booklets that are up for approval are included in the magazine one page 20 and 24. For the correct files of the literature that's up for approval we advise you to look at https://nahelp.org/fsc-2025. The Grateful Wake Up Group requested that we pull their proposal 2025-C from the agenda since motion 2025-A has the same intent.

Although it's not a very nice subject to address, I would like to mention again that last year's conference was low in attendance for various reasons. The consequences were that we had to depend on extra donations to break-even financially. So please keep informing people about the Conference and encourage people to register.

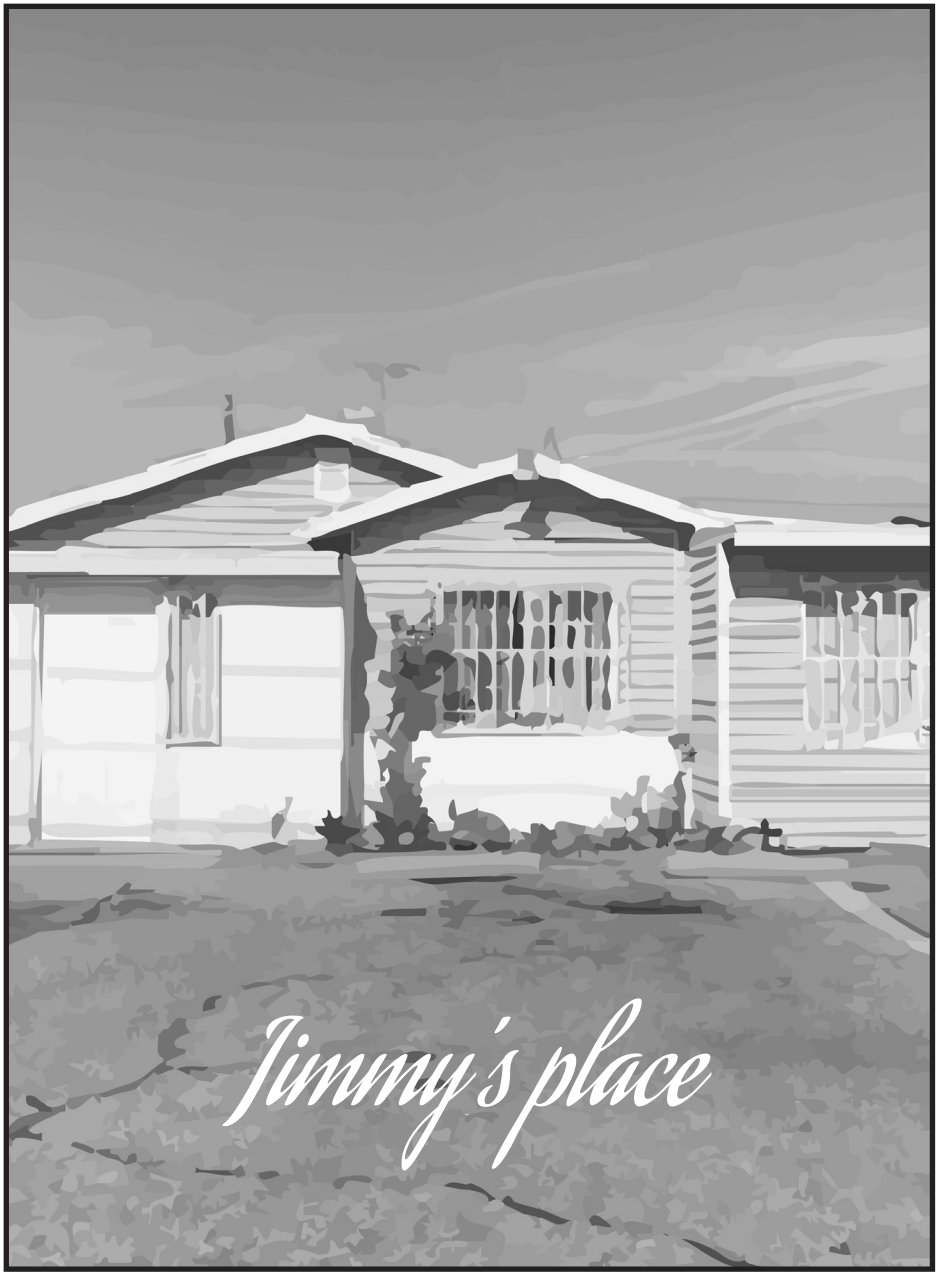
To end on a positive note, members of the Iranian fellowship have translated the ''Baby Blue'' basic text into the Farsi language, and this can be downloaded on the nahelp.org homepage. Also, there's more excitement from Russia where members are studying the Grey Book in Russian. It would be great to hear more from this at the Conference and we are looking forward to the reports from the Groups all over the world.

See you in June!

In Loving Service

Co - Chair: Shawn C - shawnc7489@gmail.com

Chair - Erik F - erikfiselier@hotmail.com - +31646711134


Jimmy's place

MOTIONS

OLD BUSINESS

2021-E

The Rabbit Meeting

To have line numbers and page numbers on every piece of review and input literature.

Intent: “to keep our review and input literature consistent,and to make it easier for input to be understood when submitted” Group

Contact Bill. C (610)809-9771

2021-F

The Rabbit Meeting

To have the name of the group added to the review and input literature “intent” to make available the group name that has written a piece of literature. The group can be asked questions during the input and review process

Group contact Bill. C (610)809-9771

2019-A

Never Alone, Never Again Group in North Carolina

Motion for ASIS to maintain a stock pile of $5000 worth of literature and phone number where groups can order literature. For this to happen ASIS would have to rent storage space and assign a trusted servant to receive and fulfill the orders.

The trusted servant assigned would need to be given access to our current printing company. This could evolve into a service center as we grow. Passing this motion in no way precludes the inventory of literature to growing beyond $5000 amount

Intent: to function more as a formal service center

*this will will be considered a returning motion when it comes back.Contact: Travis (828) 734-1877

MOTIONS

OLD BUSINESS

2024-A
Approve Personal Responsibility Booklet

Intent: Personal Responsibility has gone through the FLC and has been in curriculum for years. It has been translated into other languages. and it is openly being used by many Worldwide Groups. SO, we feel it is time to approve it as a Fellowship NA Approved Literature

2024-B
Approve the Home Group Booklet

Intent: has gone through the FLC and has been in curriculum for years. It has been translated into other languages. and it is openly being used by many Worldwide Groups. SO, we feel it is time to approve it as NA Approved Literature

Historical Perspective Group for NA
Chairperson Bill A
1-484-951-3305
matrixmatclub@yahoo.com

1st YEAR MOTIONS

NEW BUSINESS

A Way Out Group:

Proposal 2025-A
A motion that is on the agenda, that has been brought to the FSC by a Group that no longer exists or participates in the FSC, will be deleted from the agenda after a year of not being picked up by another Group.

Intent: to prevent motions from keeping returning on the agenda without a Group being responsible for the motion. also because the Groups need to be able to contact a Group about a motion.

Contact: Ramon
nazwolle@gmail.com
+31653852287

Grateful Wakeup Group:

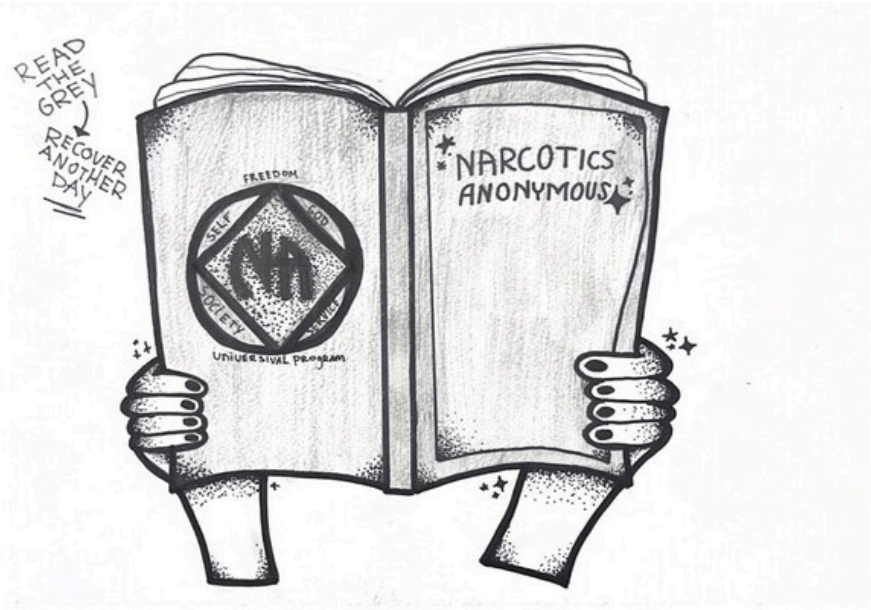
Proposal 2025-B
To formally remove abstain from the voting procedure.

Intent: to clean up confusion of the voting procedures.

Proposal 2025-D
To have the FSC Trusted Servants keep a document with all passed motions. This will include updating this document each year.

Intent: To provide clarity for the Groups of ASIS.

Contact: Eric D
ericenvisions@hotmail.com
+14026402471


READ THE GREY
RECOVER ANOTHER DAY
FREEDOM
SELF
GOD
SOCIETY
SERVICE
UNIVERSIVAL PROGRAM
NARCOTICS ANONYMOUS

Why Not from the Start?

This phrase was understood better after the Step retreat. It helped me to rethink ideas that I was confused with. Parts of each Step can be practiced from the very beginning of our Surrender. Such as parts of the 10th, 11th, and 12th Steps. It had confused me how we are taught the Steps are in order for a reason yet we are asked to carry out some of these principles from the start. While we may not have had the spiritual awakening of each Step our spirits can be awakened to doing what is right from the beginning. The simple phrase "Why not from the start" helped me quit thinking in only black and white regarding our Steps and Traditions. It helped me to see we may not have lived the Step yet but we can practice the principles of it. As I write this the First Step comes to mind. We may not truly understand we are powerless over our addiction but we still don't have to react. Obviously, we don't use no matter what. It is freeing to think of it like this rather than the idea many share about not being on a certain Step. It always seemed like excuses to me and I don't want any loopholes in my program for the disease to sneak in. It was another example of the phrase "everything is subject to revision, especially what we know about the truth."

By an anonymous addict in Nebraska

Quality Over Quantity

There is a paragraph in the header of Recovery and Relapse that states: "Many people think that recovery is simply a matter of not using drugs. They consider a relapse a sign of complete failure, and long periods of abstinence a sign of complete success. We in the recovery program of Narcotics Anonymous have found that this perception is too simplistic. After a member has had some involvement in our Fellowship, a relapse may be the jarring experience that brings about a more rigorous application of the program. By the same token we have observed some members who remain abstinent for long periods of time whose dishonesty and self-deceit still prevent them from enjoying complete recovery and acceptance within society. Complete and continuous abstinence, however, in close association and identification with others in N.A. groups, is still the best ground for growth."

I think most of us can understand this paragraph pretty easily, however, I know that I was impressed by clean time when I got here even though I did not fully understand how clean was defined in Narcotics Anonymous. I simply thought that clean meant off of street drugs. After some time on the Program, now I feel like I can really understand this paragraph. It took me two relapses in the first two years of being in NA to understand what this meant. Although complete and total

abstinence was absolutely necessary to recover from the disease of addiction, it was just the fist part of the process. Today our Home Group refers to getting clean as Step Zero. There is a series of questions in How It Works before Step One that helps us prepare for this process of recovery and we have to be ready to put all the drugs down in preparation. "We get clean to work the steps, we don't work the steps to get clean."

After that last time using, I remember being so desperate that I was willing to go to any lengths to stay clean. It's a miracle that when I was ready, I found the help I needed through addicts who carried the message of NA to me. My experience since then has been hard-won and I've had many disturbing realizations. Recovery may be simple and straightforward, but the lessons we learn can be bitter and hard to accept. One thing I have noticed from my own recovery and from those who's recovery I admire in this Fellowship is that selfless service is a byproduct of this process. I believe this is mainly evident in the surrender to being part of the Group and accepting responsibilities as a Member of that Group. If we go back to the paragraph from Recovery and Relapse for a moment. The last sentence says: "Complete and continuous abstinence, however, in close association and identification with others in N.A. groups, is still the best ground for growth". I believe that this idea of quality over quantity is important when we talk about the Group as well.

I can't tell you how many times I've heard things like "It was a great meeting, there were 50 addicts there". It would seem that the higher the attendance of meetings, the better the meeting. That is not how I understand it to work. When I hear things like this I wonder: were addicts attending because they were forced to by drug court, probation or their recovery house, or were they there because they were looking for help with their drug problem? I also wonder if there was an atmosphere of recovery in the meeting where a clear message of NA was shared. This includes our message of complete and total abstinence from all mood-changing substances and mind-altering chemicals. Was OUR message shared that addicts need to hear, or did they hear something else, something easy on the ears? I also wonder if our Twelve Traditions are being followed and applied to preserve our message and make sure that we are not in affiliation with any related facility or outside enterprise, or if our written message is given freely or sold for profit. These are just a few of the questions that come to mind.

Obviously, we desire to carry this message to as many addicts as possible and clean time is important so I don't mean to say that big meetings are bad and staying clean isn't a sign of recovery. All I'm trying to say is that in my experience, with the

state of this fellowship, when we carry a message of complete abstinence, print our own literature addicts written by addicts for addicts that is given freely, and stop violating anonymity by verifying addicts' attendance, the numbers go down at first. This is what I mean by quality over quantity when it comes to the Group. I said before that when I was ready, I found the help I needed, but does that happen for every addict? I fear that not every addict has that luxury today. When they hit bottom and find themselves in that state of complete desperation and are ready to go to any lengths to get and stay clean will they find the NA message when they go to an NA meeting, or some other message? We have an immense responsibility that they find OUR message and I think we all know that isn't the case right now.

This disturbing realization is grim but there is hope today because Groups that are doing the right things for the right reasons do exist and we are growing. There is hope today for the suffering addict that no addict need die without hearing a message of hope and promise of freedom from active addiction. I want to close this article with a line from Our Symbol: "Goodwill is best exemplified in service and proper service is "Doing the right thing for the right reason". When this supports and motivates both the individual and the fellowship, we are fully whole and wholly free."

From an anonymous addict in Ohio



Why I Stayed in NA and Support ASIS

Something happened the other day, that I never dreamt possible during my active addiction. I celebrated 2 Years of Clean Time. Before I decided that I couldn't quit using on my own and started my recovery journey at another 12 Step Fellowship, I was struggling to find help and relief from all of the physical, emotional, and spiritual pain in my life. I was going to a therapist weekly, who would constantly suggest that I start a prescription for a drug to help my diagnosis. I was also in the process of trying to obtain a legal prescription for a drug that I was using that had stopped working. I knew what The Doctor was trying to prescribe would cause more problems from the many stories of others and research that I had done myself in the past. I also knew that a legal prescription to rationalize the drug that I was obtaining, and using illegally would not magically start working again.

I was in the middle of doing my 90 in 90, making calls to other addicts, and using the 5 tools when at 53 days clean, I decided to make a major life decision on, my own. I didn't call my sponsor or another addict. Within 5 minutes I was under the influence of drugs. Immediately all of the emotional and physical pain were amplified just as bad as the day I decided that I couldn't do it on my own. Within two minutes I received a good morning text from another addict asking how I was doing. Before coming to NA, I would have ignored the message or lied because of my shame about using. A change had started inside me, my first small spiritual awakening. I immediately responded and got honest. They asked if I called my sponsor yet. I told them that it just happened and got off of the phone and called my sponsor. Something else happened that never happened before. Instead of being met with hostility, or anger, I was met with love. He suggested that I needed 2 meetings a day for 90 days. I thought this was excessive and crazy. But I found out that I really did need those two meetings a day. Sometimes at work when I was stuck in the Triangle of Self Obsession I would sneak out of work and jump on my sponsor's Home Group meeting. I would lie when he asked, I thought you were already on break or are you on lunch? I knew I needed a meeting bad, and that it helped me with my obsessive thoughts. Today I am honest with my sponsor and share everything.

I listened and still remember a lot of what other addicts who seem to show recovery working in their lives. Especially the ones who share about complete and total abstinence. I am grateful to God for bringing me to my Home Group, and putting addicts in my life that share, and live by this principle. I honestly don't know or want to find out what would have happened

if I walked into my first NA meeting and heard that it was okay for me to take that prescription the doctor was trying to prescribe, or that obtaining that legal prescription for another drug was part normalized in recovery. I honestly believe that I would not have come back and continued to fail at quitting on my own. I believe that A.S.I.S. is crucial for future addicts. I can't imagine if the original message of complete and total abstinence were no longer around to be shared or lived for others could have that change of hope that I once was so desperately looking for. At this pass F.S.C. I was saddened. This was my second year attending with my Home Group, and the number of Groups and Addicts had dropped. There were some new Groups that came for the first time. We need more Groups and Addicts to be participating.

I stay an active member of N.A. and support the A.S.I.S because I know from the experience of others and now my own life that it works. I also know that there are countless addicts right now, and in the future who will need all of our collective stories to reach them and show them that they can live a happy productive drug free life.

By an anonymous addict in Ohio

Parallels

Since I have been on the Program, I have noticed some common ideas and parallels between the Steps and Traditions and other aspects of our Program that I would like to explore more. For starters, let's look at the first thing we are tasked with when we get here; getting clean. Our message says that "An addict, any addict, can stop using drugs, lose the desire to use, and find a new way to live." I think it's in this order for a reason. It also says in the Basic Text that we cannot think our way into good living, we have to live our way into good thinking. Therefore, we have to stop using drugs first. We don't care how you do it. It can be cold turkey, in a detox or wherever, just as long as you get clean. Then, with a clear mind you can try this way of life by your own choice. In the process of finding a new way to live through the Steps the desire to use is miraculously lifted. This is the way we recover. I believe that this same idea is echoed in Steps Six and Seven when we are looking at character defects and shortcomings.

I understand that there are a lot of different ideas about what a character defect is and what a shortcoming is, and some even believe that there is no distinction between the two. One of our earlier members had a way of putting it that has stuck with me since I heard it. He said that character defects were like having a car with a flat tire and a shortcoming would

be like driving on that flat tire. I see a big similarity to this idea and getting clean and losing the desire to use. I see it as having the desire to use is a character defect and using is a shortcoming. The difference is the distinction between a thought or desire and the action of acting out on that desire. I think this same concept is how we recover after the drugs are removed from our lives. Right from the start we are told to sit on our hands or not react. It doesn't mean that we don't want to. We have character defects that cause us to act out our shortcomings. So, at some point we have to get to that point of being sick and tired or entirely ready to have these defects removed. I think this is why the Step Six essay in the Gray Book goes back to Step One to start off, it is because of this comparison.

It sounds simple to just not act out or not use but this can be really difficult. I know for me the thought of not using was impossible before coming to Narcotics Anonymous. Even after I got here, I still tried to use successfully only to find out that it was insane for me to try to do so. I needed to be totally beaten or entirely ready to have the desire to use lifted from me. This came from repeating the same insanities over and over and admitting complete defeat. When that happened, I became open to the help that was available in Narcotics Anonymous.

I heard a longtime Member say that everything in this Program is just a deeper application of the basics. In the beginning it was just don't use and go to meetings. The focus was on that one symptom of our disease, the use of drugs. As we work our way through the Steps the layers of the onion start to come off exposing our disease for what it is at its core, self-centered fear. I think a lot of this fear is fear of the unknown. We cling onto using our resentments, anger and fear because it's all we have known. To let go of them would be placing us in a place of uncertainty so we have to be completely defeated for our minds to be open to something new. That's why no one changes or stops using until they are ready.

This writing is me trying to work out this understanding so I'm not claiming that this is all exactly how it is. It is an idea that has slowly surfaced to me over the last couple of years and I thought I would share it with you all to see what you think. My mind may change as new information is revealed to me and I may be over-complicating things. Writing this is actually an attempt to simplify the Program for myself. I also don't want to over-simplify. I want to understand this Program as clearly as possible because the better I can understand it, the better I might be able to help others understand it.

From an anonymous addict in Ohio

In Narcotics Anonymous we find out that we're not alone and that's there's survivors willing to help.

In Narcotics Anonymous we learn and experience that the miracle of total abstinence from all drugs is possible, and more importantly an absolute necessity for recovery from addiction.

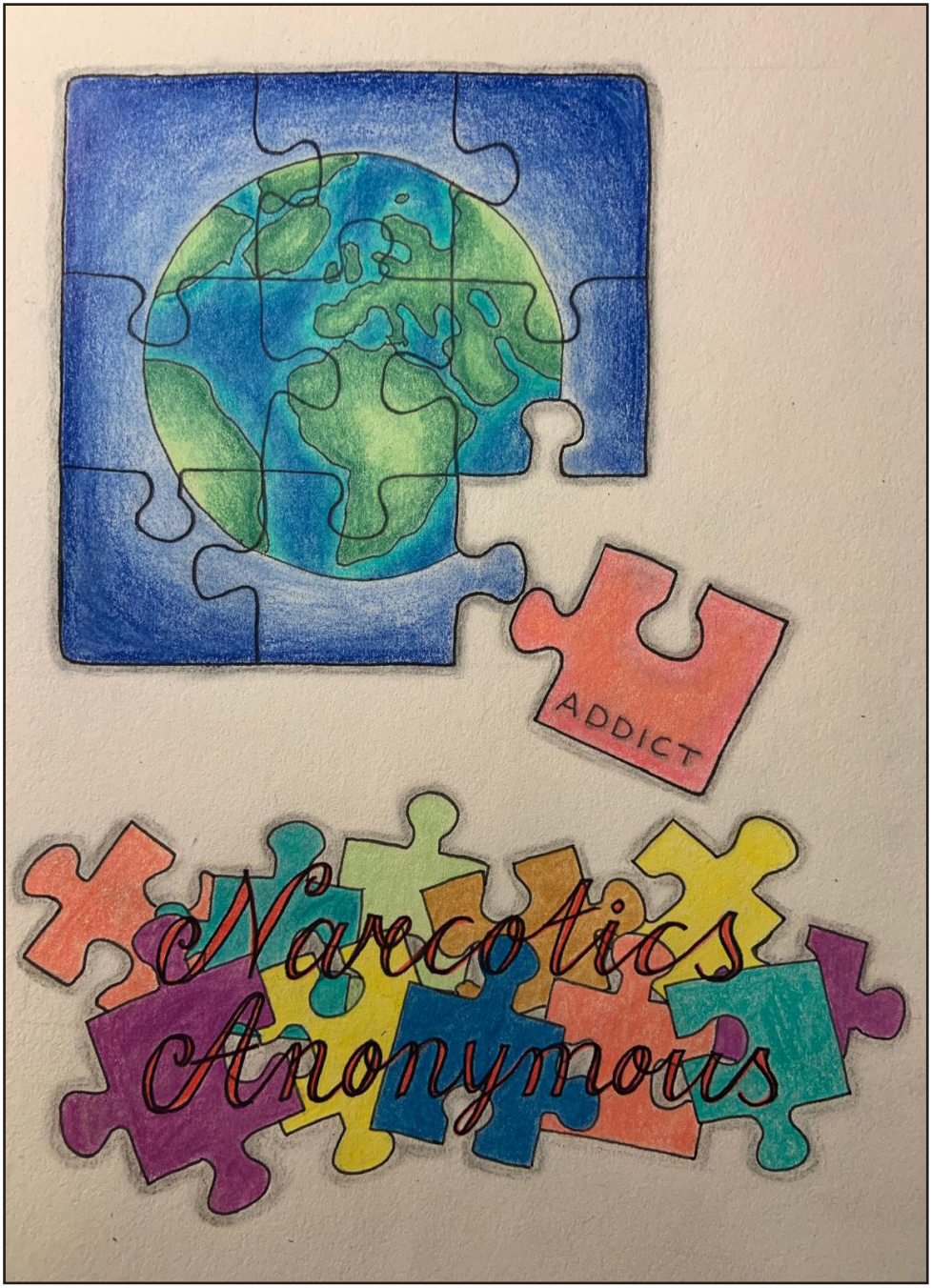
In Narcotics Anonymous we get to understand that the only thing that matters is our desire to stay clean, and that desire turned into action makes possible a new way of life.

In Narcotics Anonymous we learn that we need to get back and give back in order to keep our recovery going, and without members coming back to serve, no more Narcotics Anonymous. We are Narcotics Anonymous.

In Narcotics Anonymous we get to know ourselves as Spirit.

What does Narcotics Anonymous mean to you?

a grateful member


ADDICT
Narcotics
Anonymous

Faith is the KEY

"Faith is the key."
Grey Book p139 l25

In Paths of Recovery faith is talked about as a spiritual truth in Narcotics Anonymous. It talks about it being composed of belief, hope and acceptance. And then it continues to talk about belief, trust and acceptance. I am not sure about this being a mistake or that hope, and trust are looked at in the same way. Still it gives a beautiful threefold for understanding faith more and how this can work for us in our recovery.

Belief

"Belief is the lowest form of faith, it is conceptualization."

In our 2nd Step it talks about belief being the most important thing for us to work on. We all come into Narcotics Anonymous having some sort of faith. This can be in the area of religion, spirituality or any other concept we hold on to in our minds. I am coming to understand that this conceptualization refers to our thinking. We need sanity in this area because our way of thinking is what brings us back to our unmanageability. We have all sorts of thoughts and concepts that we have picked up along the way in life. Before, during and after our using. Having reached a point where we became desperate is proof that our belief is not working for us. Or we would not have desperation. In Narcotics Anonymous we literally surround ourselves with new thoughts by being around clean addicts who have found a new way to live. We hear their experience, suggestions and hope and this is where our belief starts to change. Our insanity starts in the way we think, and this is also where we are powerless. We cannot control our first thought. And if we do not surrender our actions these thoughts will bring us back to the same results we always had. So how do we surrender?

Trust

"Trust is the application of belief in our lives, it is action based on what we believe."

Now that we have new thoughts available to us, coming to us through the NA literature and other NA members, we can start to put them into action. This is where we start to practice trust. We might not have the experience yet, but we do have the belief of other people and can make the decision to start acting on those beliefs. "An addict alone is in bad company". Is a new concept we can put into action by forcing ourselves to be around other recovering addicts. When we do this, we get the experience of not being alone and how this affects us. This experience strengthens us in our beliefs and gives us hope that this truly works. Change is possible. And this in turn calls for more action. So maybe trust and hope go hand in hand here. This way we start to really change and start to

come to believe. Without the action we can never have the experience. So that is why it is so important that we start to act in our recovery. Our thinking cannot change while sitting on the cough. We will be stuck in the same concepts and this will give us the same experiences.

Acceptance

"Acceptance is the highest form of faith, it is instinctive rather than conceptual."

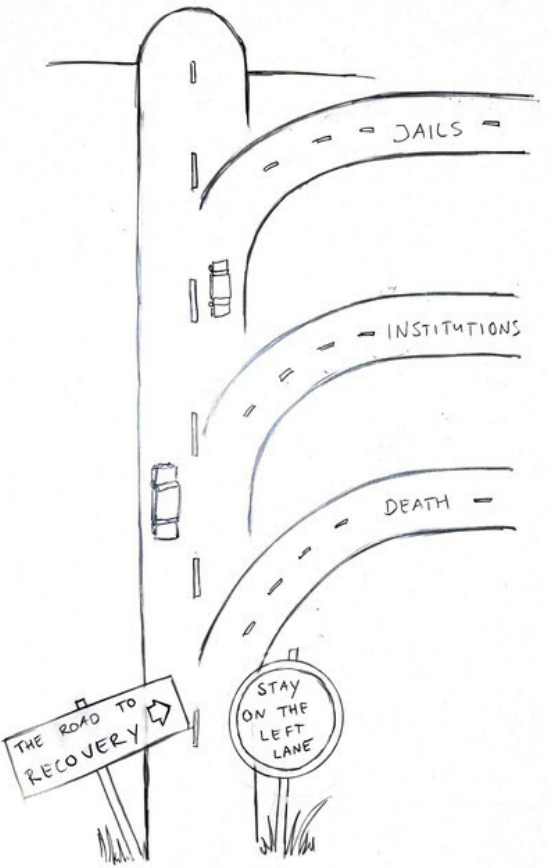
Often when we start to feel conflict again it is because we have started to believe our old concepts again. "I do not need to do this". "I can maintain it on my own". "I need to have this or that". "I am not going to make it". This will lead us back again to what we have always had. Isolation, self-pity, negativity, etc. Our acceptance fades away, and we are back to trying to control ourselves and our lives. Not aware of the beliefs we have that are controlling our lives.

Acceptance is the experience. Sitting in a meeting and just being oke, experiencing that we are better off not being alone. The action we take for our recovery becomes easier to do, it becomes a part of who we are. The more we experience this the more we believe in this way of life. Recovery is an uphill journey in this way.

We need a new belief and can get it through the NA people and program. This gives us the chance to apply it to our lives. The result is change and new experiences. Which is the opposite of insanity where we constantly experience the same.

"Faith is the key to our new way of life"

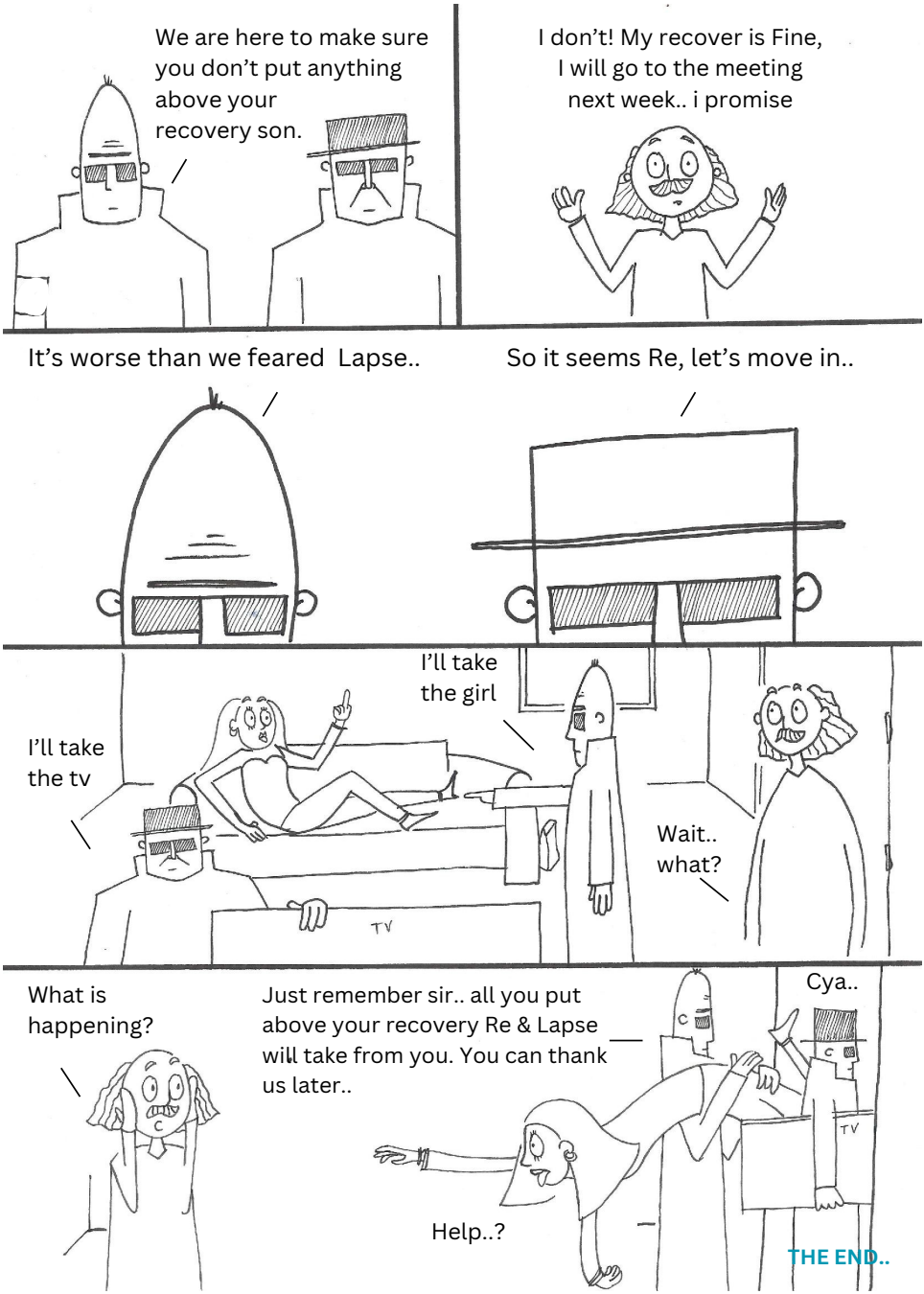
From Paths of Recovery



THE ADVENTURES OF SIR RENDER

SIR RENDER MEETS THE COMPLACEN CIA




We are here to make sure you don't put anything above your recovery son.
I don't! My recover is Fine, I will go to the meeting next week.. i promise
It's worse than we feared Lapse..
So it seems Re, let's move in..
I'll take the tv
I'll take the girl
Wait.. what?
TV
What is happening?
Just remember sir.. all you put above your recovery Re & Lapse will take from you. You can thank us later..
Cya..
Help..?
THE END..

PERSONAL RESPONSIBILITY

Many of us arrive at our first NA meeting spiritually dead, emotionally crippled and in poor physical health. Overwhelmed by shame, guilt, self-hatred and the painful rewards of our self-centered lifestyle, we are relieved to find that we have a treatable disease. In NA, we have evolved a concept of the disease of addiction as arrived at by addicts recovering in NA. Our moral values, which we thought were long gone, can be revived by living in harmony with the principles found within the 12 Steps and Traditions of NA.

One of the first and most important tools we are given in our struggle to overcome addiction is an understanding of the disease. A thorough grasp of this new-found reality has opened the door to recovery for countless addicts worldwide.

Clinging to any reservations we may have in accepting the fact that we have a disease called addiction is referred to as denial. Denial of our condition is nothing more than an invitation to further pain and confusion. Denial is the mind game that all addicts play to avoid dealing with reality and the consequences of our using. Often times our life-styles have become quite bizarre, yet we remain convinced that everything is normal. Denial is a mental operation of rationalization and justification used to shield us from the pain of our current situation.

NA offers a solution to those who stubbornly embrace denial and who doubt the fact that this disease is the source of our unmanageable lives. Having accepted our disease, we must be careful to realize that our addiction can be easily transferred to other destructive behaviors such as going to extremes in the areas of; compulsive spending, over-eating and sexual acting out. New members are especially susceptible as many will use almost anything in an attempt to fill the void and emotional emptiness left as a result of giving up the primary symptom. Although applying the Steps, going to meetings and using a sponsor does not offer the immediate gratification found in addictive lifestyle, it does offer the long term solutions we truly seek.

We know that addiction is the four-part illness. It is a physical, mental, spiritual and emotional disease. There is no greater advantage to the addict seeking recovery than learning the disease concept of addiction. This has enabled hundreds of thousands of NA members to recover. The more we understand the direct connection between our pain and our disease, the less likely we are to allow ourselves to drift back into the patterns that precede relapse. We have to take care that those symptoms of our disease such as; exerting powerless situations, credit taking, judgment of others, and reluctance to do our part, judgment of others, and reluctance to do our part do not gain control again. Pain does not cure our illness; it does motivate us to seek solutions.

The most solemn vow and the strongest will power offer only temporary solutions. In our experience, until an addict finds the sincere desire to stop using, there is little hope for recovery. It is this desire that fuels our recovery.

We have come to understand that we suffer from a disease called addiction. This disease tells us that we do not have a disease, and therefore our minds work against us. That is how it fools even the most intelligent people. If we cannot grasp the concept of addiction as an illness, as in a medical text book, we may think of it this way: the belief that this illness exists and is treatable will help us get results, while denial of its existence will kill us. While we readily admitted to powerlessness over our addiction, our addiction exists with or without drugs. Even without drugs, the disease often shows up in compulsions such as; arrogance, gambling, spending, eating, lust and generally overdoing anything that makes us feel good.

Expressing love opens the door for us to obtain freedom. We learn how to love by working the Steps and the Traditions. We learn to apply the spiritual principles embodied in them into our lives. It takes time, repeated effort and a willingness to learn real love. Many addicts have said that working with others got them through particularly tough times. When we show concern for another, we manage to divert attention from ourselves and our compulsions. We identify with the feelings that many addicts share because we have been there and done that. We have found that the only way out is by total surrender. In spite of all the denial, evasive actions and repeated attempts to use successfully, nothing seemed to work. We came to a place where recovery started sounding good, even though it meant we could not continue using. Of course, we knew there would have to be a few changes.

Our actions define our personalities to the world and our choices can rebound to us as pleasure or pain. Attitudes are the way we look at things. Attitudes

are the basis that we use to form our strategies for dealing with reality and other people. An attitude is a group of potential choices. As we change, these attitudes change. If we see something wrong within our thoughts or actions, it is our responsibility to correct the faulty perception or wrongdoing. This is one way that God assists us in the constant improvement of our surroundings and ourselves. “Houses can only make a town, it takes citizens to make a city”, reminds us that if there’s nothing living inside, we are just a shell. Some of us are still tender from the scars of active addiction and hold back from general involvement in society as a whole. As we grow in recovery, we will find ourselves taking on responsibilities before we know it.A gradual disassembly of our lives resulted as our disease progressed. We reverse this process in recovery and re-integrate into general society. Many of us have to develop restraints that we never felt like we needed before. Some of us have to develop their ability to assert themselves personally.

Our personal responsibility does not go on forever. Our disease tells us that we have power beyond the tip of our nose. We need to remember that the universe is for God to deal with. Many times, we have heard, “Through our inability to accept personal responsibilities’’ in area’s as simple as paying bills such as telephone, gas and electric but ‘personal responsibility’ goes much further than that. Personal responsibility in recovery means the process of using the tools of the Program in all areas of our lives. We must do this in our Home Groups, with our sponsors, in service work, and in our personal recovery. It involves honest sharing. We create our own problems when we do not share what is going on with us. Sharing everything is okay when we are hurting inside perpetuates a fraud on the listener who cares about us, because they expect to hear the truth from us. This is how we create our own problems. “I’ll show them,” became the battle cry of our self-pity. Self-pity is a game that we can only win by being a loser! This is how we extinguish the light in our soul without even picking up the drugs. We recover by being able to reach out when the walls are closing in on us.

Part of our disease tells us to avoid taking responsibility for our own lives. We have become quite adept at avoiding personal responsibility for our actions. We have learned to be angry and resentful of others, so it seems quite normal when we immediately seek someone to blame and resent. This is just one more way that our disease keeps us from growing and changing. “Look what they did to me!” became our war cry. We are not ‘the disease’ that we suffer from, nor are we ‘God.’ We discover what the rules are for us and strive to become ready to have God heal our defect of character and remove our shortcomings. We surrender and allow God to heal us and remove our short-

comings, and we are able to respond to life in the moment. We no longer have to live in resentment, anger and fear because we are freed from the pain of contradiction in our lives. The pathway to being the people we want to be is clear because we have a loving God working in our lives today. Knowing our disease, developing a relationship with God, and coming to know ourselves are a few of the miracles of recovery.

After working the First Step, most of us experience a sense of humility and relief that we are not in control of our addiction. This knowledge allows us to stop beating ourselves up over the things that our disease made us do. There are however, some things that we do have control over, namely our attitudes and actions. Responsibility and autonomy go hand in hand; we can no longer do whatever we want to with no accountability. The more responsible we become, the less often others have the right or need to correct us.

Actually, we may find ourselves in positions that generate harmony and order, instead of disunity and chaos for the first time in our lives. We find out exactly how our lives intertwine with the lives of others and theirs with ours. Each part ultimately affects all others and a frayed edge will destroy the whole cloth if not mended.

The Steps guide us in changing until our inner reality matches up with life around us. Things work out better if we adjust our attitudes to match reality. By a simple process of evaluation, we can respond personally. We work ourselves back into the fabric of life by doing what we can, when we can. We no longer strive to be the person we should be or even the person we could be, but to be the person we are. Personal responsibility is a duty we have to ourselves as well as the Fellowship. Responsibility requires action, both spiritual and physical. Maintaining recovery is our first responsibility. Daily maintenance evaluates our response to responsibility and we can see progress. The gifts that come from our new image of being responsible are a direct result of our meeting the needs of our fundamental obligations. As with other concepts of recovery, when we practice personal responsibility we become personally responsible for our lives and recovery.

MOTION 2024-B

HOME GROUP BOOKLET

WHAT IS A HOME GROUP AND WHY DO WE NEED ONE?

This booklet describes what a Home Group is, why we need one, and how we use one. It also describes our idea of the Home Group's responsibility to teach its members the Spiritual principles of recovery through the Steps and sharing through the Traditions.

An NA Group is a gathering of NA members who function together according to the Steps and Traditions, hold at least one regularly scheduled weekly NA meeting and are an integral part of each other's recovery.

Narcotics Anonymous is a Program of total abstinence and recovery from addiction. An NA Home Group holds meetings where committed members carry the message to the addict who still suffers.

In our Twelve-Step work, we usually try to bring a newcomer to a meeting of our Home Group. This is because the primary purpose of an NA Group is to carry the message to the addict who still suffers. Each Group naturally designs its atmosphere of recovery to meet the needs of its members. One of our basic needs as recovering addicts is to carry the message: to give it away so we may keep it. Our Group is composed of people like us whose ideas of recovery resemble ours and who want to help us while helping themselves. This makes our Group feel like home.

Home Groups are mentioned at many meetings. Ask the people attending your meeting if they have a Home Group or if they can describe what a Home Group is and how to use one. New NA members usually have little or no understanding of how a Home Group works, nor have they joined one. Some members even misunderstand the concept of a Home Group to the extent of claiming to have two or more.

One might ask, "How do I find a Home Group?" First, new members should attend all the meetings available on their meeting schedule. The reason we do this is so we can decide which meeting offers us the most comfortable atmosphere of recovery; a place where we can feel at home. After we determine which meeting we like the best, we make a commitment to ourselves to attend this meeting every week. We suggest that it be within a reasonable distance so that we cannot use

inconvenience as a reason not to attend. We suggest choosing a meeting that does not conflict with other living commitments (i.e., family, job, school, etc.) One member shares, "A Home Group is where I feel safe; a place where I am accepted for who I am. I have come to realize that an addict alone is in bad company."

When we get together, we can share feelings and thoughts with other members, and in this way, we gain the experience, strength, and hope of recovery. Sharing with the same people over a period of time creates a bond that can tie us together. This sharing can be a way the Home Group utilizes one of the most effective tools to arrest the disease of addiction. A Home Group can share in all our fears, hopes, and joys. Home Group members encourage and assist us in our recovery and celebrate clean time with us. They are reassuring, honest, and loving. We grow with them as they become a large part of our recovery. A Home Group is where we learn how to deal with life and how to live without the use of drugs. Part of recovery from addiction is learning to live life on life's terms. The people that we meet at our Home Group's meetings, who have committed themselves to working the Steps of NA, can help us stay clean through our specific living situations. Early recovery can seem like living from crisis to crisis. We not only need answers to our general questions but specific answers to our current problems. Practical sponsorship allows us to use the recovery experience of others. Our Home Group sponsors us in many ways. We learn the ideas of recovery at meetings. We learn effective ways to live clean by sharing with Home Group members after meetings and when we go out for coffee. We may even find our sponsor at our Home Group and use the Group's meeting as a place and time to share with them.

Once we choose the Group that will get to know us better than any other, we make a decision to commit ourselves to that Group. In Groups, where it is common, writing our name, address, phone number, and clean date in the Group book is an active commitment to become part of that Group and strengthen our recovery.

As we become more comfortable and familiar with the Group and its members, we will probably be asked to serve the Group in a number of different ways. Some of these are setting up, cleaning, making coffee, and chairing meetings. Becoming active in a Home Group helps us learn to be responsible for our own recovery.

Many recovering addicts talk about becoming a responsible member of society, but few talk about becoming a responsible member of a Home Group. There are responsibilities that accompany membership in a Group including regular attendance, carrying the message, welcoming the newcomer, attending business meetings, participating in the Group conscience and Group inventory meetings, and servicing the Group's needs.

The Autonomous Narcotics Anonymous Home Group is the primary unit and focus of our service structure. This is where the conscience of NA is created and devel-

oped. NA Groups decide what Narcotics Anonymous becomes.

Each NA Home Group exists in a community with different characteristics: rural, urban, suburban, etc. Each NA Home Group has a unique combination of living experiences and talents among its members. Size of the Group and interests of its members will determine the direction the Group grows in. Some Groups will be able to provide nearly all of the necessary services for themselves. Some will need to band together with neighboring Groups with similar needs to perform common services cooperatively. Our 4th Tradition autonomy and the creative freedom in our 9th Tradition provide for each Group's individual needs. Many Home Groups can and should do H&I and PI work on their own, according to their members' willingness and Group Conscience.

Our experience shows there are some general services needed. Whether our Home Group is in the city or "Small Town, USA" there are many things that each Group has in common. The obvious needs of any Group are to have responsible members to ensure the opening and closing of meetings, following the format, collecting the funds, paying rent, as well as communicating with other Groups and NA as a whole. A dependable atmosphere of recovery requires that Home Group members are responsible to open the meeting place on time and to make sure the meeting place is cleaned up and closed properly following each meeting. There should be a member who is willing and able to be a contact person to the facility where the meeting is held in case of problems.

Many Groups select a member to conduct or "chair" the meeting in an orderly recovery-oriented fashion; to see that an atmosphere of recovery is maintained during the meeting. Let's not kid ourselves, meetings do close for various reasons such as lack of participation, lack of funds, and behavior that jeopardizes the meeting place. Each Home Group has the responsibility to share with its members that inexcusable behavior cannot be tolerated lest we risk losing our meeting place. We need to be each other's eyes and ears to ensure our Home Group's meeting will stay open next week. In some cases, our irresponsible behavior has kept NA out of certain facilities. It is up to the Home Group members to make sure all the facility's rules are followed so as not to give NA a bad name.

Just as it is difficult for members to recover in isolation, Home Groups find it difficult to survive without communicating with the rest of NA. We generally select a member from our Group to inform us about and communicate with the rest of Narcotics Anonymous. This requires a member who is willing and able to represent the Group; carrying their votes, motions, and needs to other levels of service.

Groups generally select someone to be responsible for the Group's money and replenishment of its inventory (i.e., literature and supplies). Finances may be discussed at every business meeting. We, as addicts, can easily be tempted with

control so the Treasurer should be someone who will follow the Group's direction on how to spend its money. We pay rent for our meeting place and most of our other services require financial expenditures of some kind. At each of a Group's meetings, money is collected according to our 7th Tradition. Most Groups select a financially responsible, mature member with integrity to handle the Group's finances.

While a Home Group's service needs vary, most find it desirable to select trusted servants with substantial recovery and common sense. Some Home Groups are very structured with service positions and clean time requirements while others have minimal structure and clean time requirements. In all Home Groups the most important requirement is the willingness to serve. Some service positions require different skills but no position is more important than the other. There is nothing written in stone on what a Home Group must do other than keep our primary purpose – to carry the message.

One common problem we often experience as new members is placing unrealistic expectations on the Home Group and its members. Even in recovery, we may still expect people, places, and things to carry us through life. Home Group members will often share their own experiences with living problems when we ask them. However, it is not their responsibility to provide for our needs or wants such as helping us get a job or driving us to the store, etc. We soon find that other members will not let us abuse them or the Program, but they will spend all the time in the world sharing how to find this new way of life through the Steps.

Some members perceive the Home Group as a social setting. This can be a dangerous concept. Although we often think of Home Group members as our extended family, we must also remember that we are addicts and still suffer from this self-centered and self-destructive disease. At times, we may be hurt by the actions of our fellow Home Group members. Gossip, rejection, and feelings of isolation may seem to suggest that we should back away from these new friends. If we seek out a fellow member, experienced in recovery, who has gotten past these pitfalls, they can help us apply the Steps to live beyond the small-mindedness of addiction and focus us on the true meaning of a Home Group; A place to open our hearts and recovery to the addict still suffering both in and out of our rooms.

20th Annual Fellowship Service

Conference for N.A.

When: June 27th thru June 29th, 2025

Where: Hamburg, PA

Place. Olivet Mountain Camp 1540 Mountain Ave.

Hamburg, Pa 19526

Cost: $135.00 per person

Price includes all meals {and lodging if needed}

There is no registration fee all money goes directly to pay for the facility and food

Write checks payable to Historical Perspective Group

For More Information: Contact Historical Perspective Group

(610) 428-9923 Ask for Ray: or e-mail — matrixmatclub@yahoo.com

Check Out Our Web www.nahelp.org/ **Send check to: A.S.I.S. For NA**

P.O. Box 4404 Allentown, Pa 18105 Write checks payable to

Historical Perspective Group of NA (Bring sheets, pillows, Towels, and soap

everything else provided)

Name: _____ E - Mail: _____

Address: _____City _____State:

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Group Name_____ **Register by June 10, 2025**



Amount $135.00 Check NO _____



(Adversity does not build character, it Reveals it.) More Will Be Reveal


EFSC
SAVE THE DATE
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Upcoming Events

Annual 12 Step Retreat
Date: February 21st thru February 23rd, 2025
Columbiana, Ohio

19th Annual Fellowship Service Conference for N.A.
Date: June 27th thru June 29th, 2025
Hamburg, PA

EFSC NETHERLANDS
Date: September 11th thru 14th , 2025
Ambt Delden, The Netherlands

Your event here? Send information to info@nahelp.org

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Like it was when NA was new and young and life or death intense:
You matter to us so we will tell you the truth as we know it with nothing held back.

THE
NEW/OLD
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"... so that no addict seeking recovery need ever die..."
We publish your input -- the opinions presented are not necessarily those of the New/Old NA Way or Anonymi Foundation